

Chapter 60-1

Chen Liuying's big fan account had 150,000 followers and was among the first batch to like her.

They were also the first to release materials and organize giveaways, belonging to the veteran-level die-hard fans.

After she posted this Weibo, Chen Liuying's fans all called out, saying if you don't love her then don't hurt her, why did you have to unfollow and step back on her?

So the big fan edited a blog post of over 2,000 words, exposing Chen Liuying's terrible behavior.

Dating her agent while maintaining a single persona, having poor acting skills yet stepping on other actresses, appearing to be a dominant Alpha¹ on the surface but actually being a violent maniac.

Most crucially, her younger sister had once worked as Chen Liuying's assistant for over a month, and after being fired, she developed depression.

The big fan asked for a long time before learning that during work, her sister had been sexually harassed by Chen Liuying under the guise of work, but because her sister had an introverted personality and didn't dare resist, and under the high work pressure and verbal abuse from the agent, she had an emotional breakdown at one point.

She only told the truth when receiving psychological counseling.

Her sister applied to be Chen Liuying's assistant because her older sister had been constantly promoting Chen Liuying, causing her to have deep filters² for Chen Liuying.

But she never expected that after going there, she would suffer inhuman treatment.

When her sister was fired, all her electronic devices were checked, and her private photo albums were also searched through, fearing she would post comments unfavorable to the artist on the internet after leaving.

The assistant had signed a contract with the company that after leaving, she would not discuss anything related to Chen Liuying in public places or on social media platforms.

Even so, when she left, her social media accounts were still checked, seriously violating personal privacy.

Most crucially, the assistant had private photos stored in her photo album and cloud storage, and when the relevant inspection personnel saw these photos, they openly discussed and mocked her figure, even suggesting they wanted to hook up with her.

These things piled up together, making the big fan's sister constantly doubt herself, washing her face with tears every day.

After the big fan learned about these things, she tore up countless Chen Liuying merchandise, but because she feared the high penalty of one million yuan in breach of contract fees, she only dared to say some seemingly fake but true information on anonymous platforms.

Her personal account had also not posted any new materials for a week, and even changed her personal bio to: "Never again."

Everyone thought she had some family matter, and only a few people sent private messages to comfort her, while most people turned to other big fans.

As a big fan, she had agent Bai Weiwei's WeChat in her contact list, but after she questioned a few sentences, Bai Weiwei threatened her that if she exposed these things, her sister's private photos would also appear on internet platforms.

Then she deleted her WeChat.

She wasn't some wealthy heiress and simply couldn't fight against the other party.

But her sister's current situation was very poor, having nightmares every day, locking herself in her room and washing her face with tears.

She lived in guilt every day.

No matter how she thought about it, she couldn't swallow this anger, but she didn't know what to do.

She had intimate photos of Chen Liuying and Bai Weiwei in her hands, and with just this point alone, she could make Chen Liuying lose countless fans.

Just when she was struggling with not knowing what to do, someone with the ID "Leo" contacted her, caring about her sister's physical condition, then said they were willing to pay a high price for the photos in her hands, would remove her completely from the incident, and if Chen Liuying's side used unfair contract terms to sue them, the other party would take full responsibility.

The big fan initially didn't dare believe it, but the other party revealed their identity, saying they were an employee of Minghui Jewelry and were currently handling related incidents. She reinstalled the long-deleted Weibo and only then discovered that Chen Liuying was currently hanging high on the trending searches.

The other party offered extremely favorable conditions, so she sent all the things she had to the other party.

All the photos were exposed through marketing accounts, with intimate photos from various angles circulating online.

The big fan posted this Weibo originally just to vent her anger, but she didn't expect Chen Liuying's fans to still come to her Weibo to whitewash, which really made her angry, so she posted a long article describing her sister's situation.

Of course, everyone initially didn't believe it.

Until an ID called "Chen Liuying's Former Assistant" posted a video.

The video showed a hotel, with the camera shaking chaotically so nothing could be seen clearly, but the audio track was the key.

Chen Liuying used a very lustful voice to say: "Your skin is really nice, can I eat it?"

A very weak female voice refused: "Don't... no..."

Then there was the girl's tearful pleading, while Chen Liuying said with satisfaction: "Not bad."

The person with the ID "Chen Liuying's Former Assistant" also issued a lawyer's letter, not only suing Chen Liuying and Bai Weiwei, but also suing their unscrupulous company Jingyi Culture behind them.

Netizens who had been following this matter discovered that the law firm helping her former assistant issue the lawyer's letter was a well-known firm in the industry that ordinary people couldn't afford.

So...

A bold speculation spread online—it was Minghui Jewelry/Dongheng Group manipulating everything behind the scenes.

Evidence came pouring in, with all evidence released almost simultaneously, not giving even a moment's breathing space.

All claims would be supported by audio and video evidence, without any dilution or impurities.

The audio from Xu Qingzhu's side actually wasn't enough to prove that Chen Liuying was sexually harassing, after all, it was just saying a few complimentary words with a strange tone, but combined with the information exposed by her former assistant, it could almost perfectly nail it down.

In the following half hour, that video segment combined with the recording became a subtitled version, and netizens watched the entire segment like appreciating a movie.

After watching, they only wanted to say—Chen Liuying deserved to die.

The name that had been hanging on trending searches for an entire day once again exploded on social media, just in a different way.

The people who had spoken for Chen Liuying during the day, the fans who had followed her Weibo, all felt complicated after seeing all the evidence.

Too damning.

They got the hammer they asked for.

Not only sexually harassing employees, but also dating her agent, and even daring to flirt with a rich second-generation female CEO.

Most crucially, she actually turned the tables and blamed others!

The fans felt like monkeys being played around.

So they quickly turned from fans to haters, becoming the sharpest knives to slaughter Chen Liuying's comment section, plaza, and super topic³.

Combined with the fans of Zhao Ying and Yang Shuyan, Chen Liuying's Weibo comments quickly exceeded one million, two million...

And still increasing.

Her name, together with Bai Weiwei's, was hung at the highest position.

Of the top ten trending searches, she occupied five, with several others being about Xu Qingzhu and Minghui Jewelry.

This day's Weibo trending topics were quite lively indeed.

Everything was developing in the direction Liang Shi had predicted.

After Dongheng Group and Minghui Jewelry's official statements and lawyer's letters were released, netizens began eating melons⁴.

After eating them all, they couldn't help but wail: [I'm like a jumping badger in a melon field! Is there a class representative to summarize?!]

[Just how many more surprises does this Chen Liuying have that I don't know about? Why can so many people hammer her at the same time?]

[This is probably what happens when you offend capital. *lights cigarette sadly.jpg*]

[...]

Footnotes:

¹ **Dominant Alpha:** Refers to the Alpha role in ABO (Alpha-Beta-Omega) dynamics, a fictional social hierarchy where Alphas are typically dominant personalities

² **Filters:** Internet slang meaning having a positive, idealized view of someone, often blinding one to their flaws

³ **Super topic:** A feature on Weibo (Chinese Twitter equivalent) where fans gather to discuss specific topics or celebrities

⁴ **Eating melons:** Chinese internet slang for consuming gossip or watching drama unfold online

Chapter 60-2

8:00-10:00 PM was the best time for internet traffic, when fan activity on various platforms reached its peak, but tonight had a distinctly dominant feel.

Because the drama was unfolding on Weibo, with multiple melons¹ blooming together, people could eat gossip until they were stuffed every minute.

Weibo's traffic reached its peak at 9:30 PM.

Because within less than an hour, four companies announced they were changing their spokespersons, and one production crew announced they were terminating their cooperation with Chen Liuying.

The resources Chen Liuying had were disappearing at lightning speed.

Meanwhile, in the seventh-floor office of Jingyi Culture, the atmosphere seemed frozen.

Bai Weiwei's computer and phone were both set to silent mode, and the office phone line had also been unplugged.

Chen Liuying looked down at the reversed online public opinion, her phone nearly crashing from the constant backend message notifications.

After a period of silence, Chen Liuying looked coldly at Bai Weiwei: "This is the result you confidently guaranteed, and then what?"

Bai Weiwei's hair was disheveled, making her look like a madwoman. She said with red eyes: "It's impossible..."

"What's impossible about it?" Chen Liuying gritted her teeth, "Things have already turned out this way."

"There must still be a way to turn this around..." Bai Weiwei's voice trembled, "This definitely isn't the final result."

She had just reopened her computer when she heard a "bang—" sound.

The door was kicked open.

A man in a black suit walked in, holding a stack of documents. With a wave of his hand, the A4 papers scattered throughout the entire office like falling snow.

The man's furious voice rang out: "What are you two doing?!"

Bai Weiwei immediately stood up: "President Wu, please let me explain..."

"What else is there to explain?!" President Wu stared at the two of them, then sneered after scanning around: "Chen Liuying, how long have you been in this industry? Getting so arrogant?"

"And you, Bai Weiwei, I cultivated you as an excellent agent, and what's the result?! You fucking committed the biggest taboo right off the bat! Dating an artist, do you have any shame left?!" President Wu's voice was deep and resonant, his scolding loud enough for the entire company to hear, "You two really don't want any face at all! Now you've caused this mess, who's going to clean it up?"

"Sorry..." Bai Weiwei stood there, her eyes bloodshot. Even though she was furious to the extreme, she still lowered her voice: "I will handle this matter properly."

"Handle my ass." President Wu said: "The CEO of Dongheng called me personally, you two..."

He paused, "Get ready to apologize and withdraw from the industry."

Both Bai Weiwei and Chen Liuying were shocked: "What does that mean?!"

"Chen Liuying, do you still remember how many endorsement deals you have?" President Wu looked at Chen Liuying, then gestured for his secretary to speak.

"You have three brand endorsements, two Asia-Pacific endorsements, one brand ambassador position, totaling 7.8 million yuan. When these contracts were signed, they all had a clause: if the first party causes brand losses due to personal reasons, compensation will be ten times the amount." The secretary said: "Currently we've received messages from all partners requesting contract termination and compensation, and..."

The secretary paused, looking at President Wu. President Wu had already closed his eyes, too lazy to look at these two troublemakers again.

The secretary announced like a robot: "All partners have issued lawyer's letters, and in the contract the company signed with you, there's also a clause that if you cause damage to the company's reputation or partner contract cancellations due to personal reasons, you must compensate the company ten times your salary."

Chen Liuying immediately said: "President Wu, you can't do this..."

"Before you fucking say that, look at what you've done!" President Wu couldn't help but curse: "Dating your agent, and then going to harass Dongheng Group's third wife, don't even look at what kind of low-class goods you are, you're not even worthy of carrying her shoes, yet you want to reach the sky in one step. Now it's good, you deserve to be shattered to pieces."

Chen Liuying: "..."

"The company has already initiated legal proceedings, the lawyer's letter will also be published online when the time comes, and the subpoena will be mailed to your home." President Wu's voice was cold: "You can spend the rest of your life diligently paying debts. As for the entertainment industry, you've reached the end of the road."

"President Wu..." Bai Weiwei seemed to wake from a dream, her voice hoarse: "President Wu, give me one more chance... I can definitely turn this around..."

"Turn around my ass!" President Wu, who had already walked to the door, stopped and looked back at her with disgust: "Your Bai family is almost bankrupt, what are you going to fight Dongheng and Minghui with?! If I were you, I'd go home and inherit the family business. Why use that bit of cleverness here instead of somewhere useful, just for this thing, making yourself neither human nor ghost!"

Bai Weiwei's tears fell from the corners of her eyes, crying silently.

President Wu said coldly: "The company will also sue you for the illegal contracts you made behind the company's back. Now you can pay debts together with her, go to court, go to prison—you'll have plenty to play with."

After saying this, he couldn't help but curse: "Idiots."

After President Wu left, Bai Weiwei's body went limp and collapsed.

She still couldn't understand how things had turned out this way.

According to Xu Qingzhu's personality, it should have been impossible.

How could she simultaneously coordinate so many people? Whose idea was it?

After a long while, Chen Liuying said angrily: "It's all your fault! I told you not to provoke Xu Qing..."

"Blame me?!" Bai Weiwei heard this and sat up to glare at her, her throat like it had been ground by sand, coarse and rough: "Didn't I ask you? What exactly did you say to Xu Qingzhu?! What did you do?! Chen Liuying, are you a sow in heat² who thinks about nothing but mating..."

"Slap—"

A crisp slapping sound rang out.

Bai Weiwei looked at Chen Liuying in disbelief, only to see Chen Liuying glaring at her viciously, grabbing her hair with one hand and yanking it back, pulling until Bai Weiwei's scalp went numb.

She seemed to see a demon walking from hell.

Chen Liuying slapped her face again. Before long, both sides of her face were burning and swelling at a visible rate: "If it weren't for you, would things have developed to this point?"

"You still have the face to blame me?" Chen Liuying yanked her entire body backward: "I told you to cause less trouble, didn't you understand? Now you've harmed me like this, are you fucking happy?!"

Bai Weiwei was seeing this side of Chen Liuying for the first time.

More real than any performance.

She was scared and trembling, then was thrown down by the irritated Chen Liuying and kicked.

In the empty, silent office, Bai Weiwei lay on the cold floor.

Closing her eyes, she heard advice that had once reached her ears.

—Her temper isn't as good as you think.

—She's trying to control you.

—She doesn't love you as much as you think.

—Weiwei, let's go see the ocean together next year, okay?

Zhao Xuning and Xu Qingzhu's voices overlapped in her ears.

Too bad she never listened.

Some people, one wrong step leads to every step being wrong.

When you embark on this road of no return, there's no way back.

Footnotes:

¹ **Eating melons:** Chinese internet slang for consuming gossip or watching drama unfold online

² **Sow in heat:** Crude insult comparing someone to an animal in mating season, implying they're only thinking about sex

Chapter 60-3

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At 9:40 PM.

Minghui Jewelry's official Weibo took advantage of this wave of traffic that almost crashed Weibo's servers to announce the spokesperson for their autumn series—Yang Shuyan.

A strong alliance.

And it was free publicity.

So at Liang Shi's suggestion, Xu Qingzhu started a livestream at the same time and connected with Yang Shuyan.

As the mastermind behind the scenes, Liang Shi didn't speak.

Xu Qingzhu never used beauty filters when livestreaming. Even though it was night, even though she'd been tired all day and the makeup she'd put on in the morning was almost gone, her looks still held up, not losing out at all when on screen with Yang Shuyan, a beauty with strong features.

Liang Shi suggested she livestream with Yang Shuyan based on two points: to build momentum for Minghui Jewelry's new products at this critical juncture; to clearly explain what happened during the day.

Online, you could choose not to establish a persona, but you couldn't be a soft target that anyone could knead.

Moreover, Xu Qingzhu's image was good. Once she started streaming, countless face-value fans¹ would flood in, which was nothing but beneficial for Minghui Jewelry.

Having Xu Qingzhu promote her own products would naturally have more advantages.

For Yang Shuyan, publicly taking sides at this critical juncture wasn't necessarily a good thing.

But Yang Shuyan wasn't afraid, and even proactively proposed cooperating with Minghui Jewelry—it was like a big pie falling from the sky, and she'd be letting the pie down if she didn't catch it.

This also made Liang Shi more curious about Lin Luoxi and Yang Shuyan's relationship, so before the livestream started, Liang Shi quietly asked about it.

Lin Luoxi coughed lightly and said half-concealing: "Just a relationship where we fought together before."

Liang Shi had always been able to control her curiosity, so she didn't ask further.

The livestream connection between Xu Qingzhu and Yang Shuyan was quickly pushed to the front of trending searches by netizens.

Netizens' emotions from cursing Chen Liuying hadn't yet calmed down when they clicked in and saw—two beautiful women.

So they began spreading the word.

More and more people came in, and Xu Qingzhu's Weibo followers were also increasing rapidly.

In just a short while, they increased by over 300,000.

Bullet comments² flashed across:

[Wuwuwu, this is paradise for face-value fans.]

[I really didn't expect that the forbidden CP³ I once shipped would have a day where they're on screen together.]

[This is so beautiful, my tears are flowing uncontrollably from the corners of my mouth.]

[How did these sisters grow to be so beautiful, awoo, I can't help but want to lick the screen.]

[Is this really not a dream? What immortal descended to bless us mortals?]

[...]

The comments refreshed very quickly, but there were many coming to praise Xu Qingzhu.

Before Xu Qingzhu started streaming, Liang Shi had already prepared an outline for the livestream, so when she first started, she spoke warmly: "I need to take up a bit of everyone's time first to explain what happened during the day. Because the other party and I have known each other for a long time, I didn't want it to come to this, but I didn't expect... I'm still sorry for affecting everyone's good mood all day."

These words were spoken with proper restraint and advancement, and combined with Xu Qingzhu's voice, had an unexpected effect.

Because Xu Qingzhu's voice was already cool and clear, and matched with her cold, gorgeous face, everyone had originally imagined a female boss image, but they didn't expect that for Xu Qingzhu's first livestream, she was a bit nervous. When speaking, she stuttered a bit, then lowered her head and made a gesture of biting her tongue, combined with her deliberate smile.

It made people feel she was extremely adorably silly.

Contrast cuteness⁴ had always been a relatively useful way in the entertainment industry to establish a persona and attract fans, but no one expected Xu Qingzhu to be self-taught.

Liang Shi had never thought about establishing a persona for Xu Qingzhu.

Very simply, Xu Qingzhu would develop in the company in the future, with a future blueprint of a business empire, not a dog-eat-dog entertainment industry.

So there was no need at all.

But now it was also an unexpected joy.

After explaining that matter, Xu Qingzhu chatted with Yang Shuyan about this autumn's new products.

She had someone bring over today's new products and said some would be gradually released later, so everyone should stay tuned.

She earnestly explained the name, style, and meaning of each product in front of the camera. Yang Shuyan, as a qualified supporting role, interjected appropriately at times.

The livestream room achieved unexpected results and quickly became the number one in popularity.

Besides Yang Shuyan, this huge traffic source, some people came specifically to see who the female lead at the center of the day's storm was, only to discover... she was really beautiful.

This appearance was simply here to bless all of humanity's eyes.

So the comment section became a large-scale rainbow fart⁵ scene.

Some people had never followed Minghui Jewelry's autumn new product launch before, or even paid attention to jewelry at all, but they fell into Minghui Jewelry's trap that night.

[Just for this face, this voice, I'll buy whatever she says.]

[Just post the link directly, I can do it, even if I have to sell everything.]

[I just want to know how much I need to buy to marry President Xu home, I really... *drools*... so hungry...]

Xu Qingzhu had just finished introducing a product and was resting when she saw the comment, so she read it out in her cool voice, then frowned and answered: "You don't need to sell everything to buy, jewelry is worn to make yourself happy. Different jewelry can give you different moods, so there's no need to buy a lot, just buy according to your needs."

"As for how much you need to buy to marry me home... sorry, you can't." Xu Qingzhu took the next product from the staff, glanced at Liang Shi who was seriously looking at backend data across from her, "I'm married."

Hearing this, Liang Shi looked up, only to find that Xu Qingzhu had already entered the next segment and started introducing the next product.

This one was designed by Zhou Yi'an.

Xu Qingzhu didn't introduce it briefly just because it was designed by Zhou Yi'an. On the contrary, she very earnestly introduced this product, even bringing up the RT Emerging Designer title, saying this work wasn't even her most impressive design—there were even better ones to come.

But even just this one was enough to amaze many people.

The bold color matching and simple yet charming design was eye-catching.

So many people went to the official website to pre-order.

In a corner no one noticed, Zhou Yi'an looked up from the game on her phone, glanced at her, her gaze profound.

After introducing today's new products, Xu Qingzhu chatted with Yang Shuyan about her future schedule, treating it as publicity for Yang Shuyan's new drama.

Yang Shuyan's future schedule was also simple—new dramas were still being negotiated, and already-aired dramas were all popular, so there wasn't much to promote.

Xu Qingzhu also wasn't very able to adapt to this atmosphere. She didn't really know what to say to liven things up.

Yang Shuyan was also a topic terminator⁶.

The atmosphere between the two was a bit awkward.

Someone suggested they randomly select comments and answer questions.

So they began selecting fan comments.

The first question selected was: Does President Xu intend to enter the entertainment industry? You're too beautiful, it's hard not to like you.

Footnotes:

¹ **Face-value fans:** Fans who follow someone primarily because of their physical appearance

² **Bullet comments:** Real-time comments that scroll across the video screen, popular in Asian streaming platforms

³ **CP:** "Couple Pairing" - fans who ship two people as a romantic couple

⁴ **Contrast cuteness:** The appeal created when someone's behavior contradicts their appearance or usual demeanor

⁵ **Rainbow fart:** Chinese internet slang for excessive, colorful compliments

⁶ **Topic terminator:** Someone who unintentionally kills conversations with their responses

Chapter 60-4

Xu Qingzhu smiled and answered: "No, my focus is still on the company. I haven't studied professionally, so I won't compete with professionally trained people for jobs."

The second question was: What will Sister Yan's next drama be? Is it true that you're collaborating with Zhao Ying?

When Yang Shuyan read the two words "Zhao Ying," her tone was slightly lingering, but she quickly adjusted and replied coolly: "The script is still being selected. If there's an opportunity to collaborate with Teacher Zhao, I naturally won't refuse."

It was a response so smooth that no fault could be found.

The third comment selected was: You guys really must go watch the CP-oriented edits on P Station¹, they're at a level that would make even dogs scream!

P Station and CP-oriented edits were unfamiliar terms to Xu Qingzhu. She frowned at the screen and asked: "What does that mean?"

Everyone in the office shook their heads: "..."

So the comments frantically flooded the screen, saying it was a video an UP master² edited of you two, go watch it quickly.

No one in the comment section was cursing; it unexpectedly and harmoniously became a science education and groundhog screaming scene³.

Seeing everyone so enthusiastic, Xu Qingzhu felt embarrassed to refuse, so she followed the comment section's instructions to open her phone, download the app, then search for her and Yang Shuyan's names in the search box.

...

#The Noble and Cold Alpha Who Stole Love X The Boss Omega Who's Cold Outside But Cries in Bed#

#Yang Shuyan Xu Qingzhu CP-oriented Mix: Crybaby Alpha X Top Omega#

#A Red Apricot Emerges from the Wall⁴: Forbidden Love#

#Love Transcending a Thousand Years, Willing to Overturn the World Just to Find Her#

These strange titles were mixed in, but the covers were all screenshots of her and Yang Shuyan together, with ambiguous looks that could practically create silk threads between their gazes.

Xu Qingzhu said in surprise: "I haven't even met Teacher Yang before, how could there be screenshots together?"

Yang Shuyan, being more worldly, replied coolly: "Photoshopped."

The comments had already exploded.

[I really thought she was a boss, but why is she so adorably silly.]

[I really want to rua all her soft places, wuwuwu, I love this type so much.]

[I really want to become the button on her shirt, *drools*, so hungry.]

[Why didn't the comment above turn red? I don't understand.]

[...]

Xu Qingzhu glanced at the rapidly scrolling comments, then casually clicked on a CP-oriented mix.

She deliberately picked one with a profound and meaningful title: #Love Transcending a Thousand Years#.

The comments went even crazier.

[Oh my god, she actually clicked on the best-looking one.]

[When I watched this, I was wuwuwu-ing under my blanket... the sexual tension is maxed out.]

[After watching this, I even had the illusion that they're a real couple.]

[...]

Having never been exposed to this field before, Xu Qingzhu didn't know what was happening. She looked completely calm as she clicked in, then saw Yang Shuyan dressed in red.

It was exactly the scene from the movie she'd watched that day, with a BGM of a magnificent and heroic tune.

Xu Qingzhu herself really liked Yang Shuyan's styling in that movie, so she watched quite engrossed.

Until she saw herself in it.

They clearly never had a single scene together, yet it was edited to create that lingering, tender feeling.

As if the two were lovers who'd been in love for years, then were forcibly separated, and there were even... bed scenes.

In the video, Yang Shuyan took off her red outer garment, revealing her fair shoulders and neck.

[I saw President Xu swallow, is this real?]

[Oh ho? Here comes the most exciting part.]

[This isn't something a elementary school student should watch.]

Xu Qingzhu felt a bit embarrassed and pinched her earlobe. Just as she couldn't bear it and wanted to close it, Sally's voice suddenly rang out in the office: "Leo, why are your eyes red?"

So everyone looked at Liang Shi in unison.

Liang Shi rubbed her eyes, her voice cool: "Are they?"

Xu Qingzhu immediately closed her phone and showed an unprecedentedly obedient and pitiful expression as she looked at Liang Shi.

But Liang Shi turned her phone screen around, showing exactly the video Xu Qingzhu had just been watching.

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

Footnotes:

¹ **P Station:** Refers to video sharing platforms (like Bilibili in China) where users post fan-made content

² **UP master:** The content creator who uploads videos on Chinese video platforms

³ **Groundhog screaming:** Reference to the screaming groundhog meme, used to express extreme excitement or shock

⁴ **A Red Apricot Emerges from the Wall:** Chinese idiom originally meaning a wife having an affair, here used to suggest forbidden or secret romance